



Treenet Checklist

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Safety disclaimer: Educational only. Use rated gear and proper tree protection. Check local laws and permissions. Consult a qualified arborist for tree health. Aim for a minimum 4:1 safety factor. Avoid dynamic loading. Build redundancy into critical points. Inspect before and after each use. Have an emergency plan. ;)

Overview:

- Knots:
 - double fisherman's OR loop and two half hitches
 - simple overhand
 - constrictor's hitch
 - double/triple wrap
 - clove hitch (with half hitch secure at end)
 - *alpine butterfly*
- Materials:
 - knife
 - lighter
 - >20m static perimeter rope
 - ~80m 550 paracord
 - 20m *skeleton rope*
 - 20-40m *scaffolding rope*
 - *sidewall perimeter rope*
- Location
- Tree choice
- Starting

- Side walls

KNOTS

Level 1 – learn the knots.

Level 2 – learn to do the knots while maintaining tension on the line (pinching is your friend).

Level 3 – learn to do the knots left to right, right to left, upside down, one handed, all while in tension; this will probably come in time, just start your first net, that's how you'll get better.

Perimeter

- double fisherman's



Clean, but then you NEED a tensioning tactic (I have a video on that)

OR

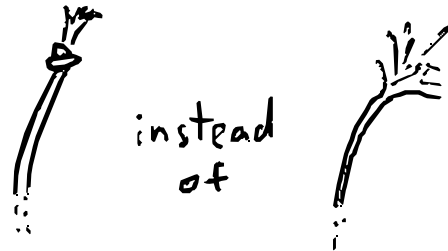
- loop and two half hitches



Not as tiny and clean, but simpler, can do without separate tensioning

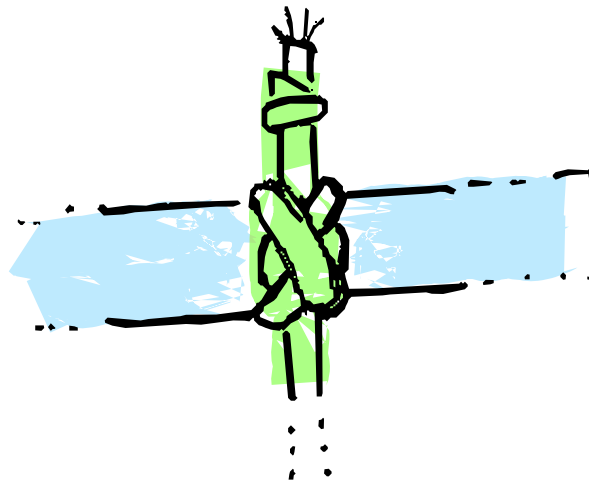
Weave

- **simple overhand**



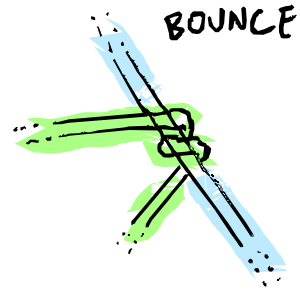
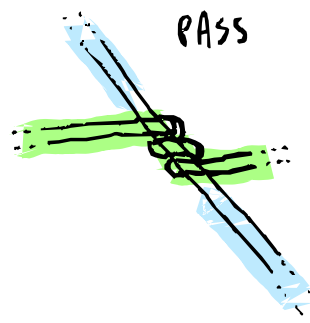
To stop paracord from fraying; burning off each of these ends takes too much time for my liking

- **constrictor's hitch**



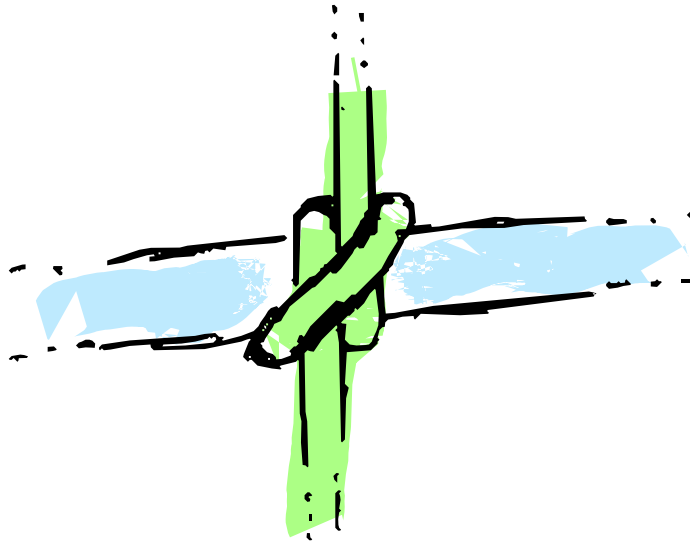
To START your weave string

- **double or triple wrap**



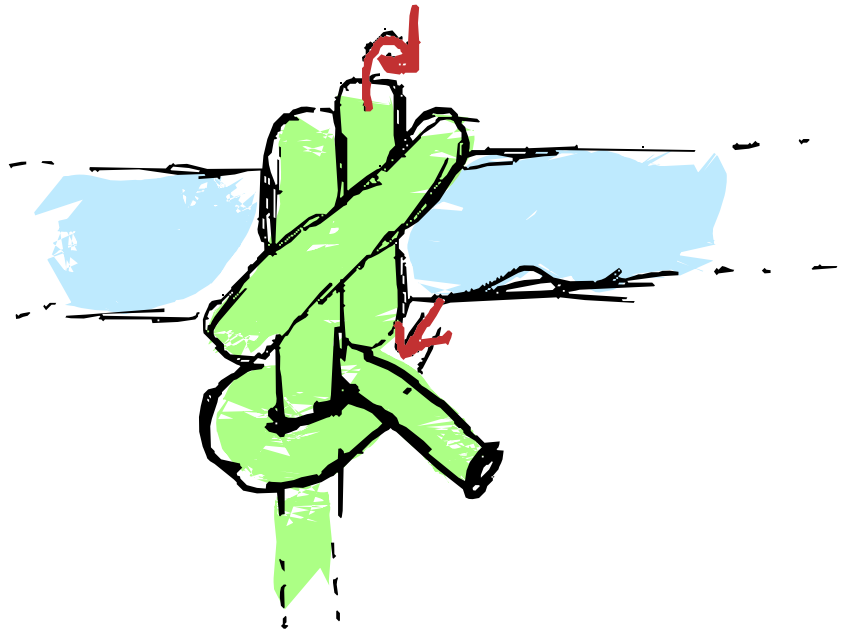
Whenever crossing another string or bouncing back from it. Only bounce backs will tension the net!

- **clove hitch**



General rule – whenever encountering a thicker rope (some exceptions, I will have a weaving video on this; I like to have at least two bounce backs before another clove hitch, so tension evens out better)

- **clove hitch with a half hitch secure**



When ending a weave strand, I like to secure the clove hitch with an additional half hitch back on the paracord itself. Otherwise the clove hitch can shake slightly loose.

(scaffolding)

Knots you will be able to untie, to remove the scaffolding after!

- **alpine butterfly**

the loop to start scaffold perimeter; you won't be able to undo most other loop knots! Maybe a bowline... Personally I like the alpine

- **two half hitches**

when other perimeter end goes through alpine loop, to lock it

- **clove hitches**

for everything else

MATERIALS

Knife

To cut everything.

Lighter

I don't use it for the paracord, those I just tie off with a simple overhand to stop fraying. But the perimeter, and potentially the skeleton, will be difficult if not impossible to just tie off. They will need something to clean the ends. Easiest? A lighter.

Perimeter

- **static rope**, ~12mm diameter, >20m length (varies), ~2000-4000kg or ~20-40kN strength

Length varies from net size, obviously. I usually go out with 20 meters, and it has been enough. Of course if you know you want a big net, do rough calculations and take EXTRA. If not enough perimeter rope, don't try to connect it with paracord... Maybe make half the net that day? Add the other half on a later day.

Personally, I use 8mm UV-resistant polyester (NOT to be confused with polypropylene or polyamide/nylon) rated for 1080kg. This is LOW END for strength! I always have a backup in the form of the wall, which means another perimeter rope higher that is weaved down.



If trying to get by with home depot only, and they don't have polyester, only PP and nylon... Nylon is stretchy, which isn't optimal for the perimeter. But PP isn't too strong. When I faced this choice, I made a THICK PP perimeter. But now that I've found polyester I am NEVER going back.

Weave

- **550 paracord**, 4mm diameter, ~80m for first day

Classic to use is nylon, where I live best I've found is PP paracord, says it is 3.2mm diameter, but feels thicker than other 4mm rope I've used (the other I've tried is 4mm polyamide string; I've snapped a couple of these when friction comes into play, during scaffolding or when trying to secure around a branch; it also feels narrow and hurts to sit on single strands).



If looking for alternatives, what to consider. On a finished net they won't really be taking much weight individually. There will be some abrasion (in wraps, knots, and if touches a tree). You will be sitting on it! (4mm paracord feels fine, random 4mm polyamide/nylon string felt like it dug into me)

(skeleton)

Static rope, thinner than diameter, usually thicker than paracord, that keeps the net from sagging as much in the middle.

For smaller nets not needed, for bigger the sag in the middle can become noticeable without it.

I use 6mm polyester, 20m usually more than enough.

(scaffolding)

Need for it depends on access to your net. If planning to build at height, take some scaffolding rope.

I use 12mm polypropylene home depot rope.

Around 20–40m (bare minimum is a perimeter of scaffold; I like a sparse net, which means roughly double rope usage of the perimeter).

(sidewall perimeter)

Not guaranteed you'll get to doing the sidewall within your first day.

I use 6mm polyester, rated for 600kg. This is on the low end strength! To be safe, can just use the same type of rope as for the perimeter.

LOCATION

- **distance from home**

If you want to go there frequently – don't have it too far from home! I live in the city, treenets are where I escape to from the city. 1 hour, quite far, won't go there daily. 30min, okeyish, if it is an awesome place it's worth it. 10min, amazing, that can be a daily retreat location. (I have a net at each of these distances, so I have somewhere to go no matter how much time I have)

- **the view**

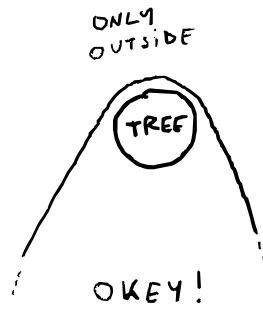
Overlooking water – a VIBE (and the sounds!)

- **sneakiness**

Don't be too visible by passersby, it is nice to have some privacy in your net. Though people are surprisingly blind to things above them

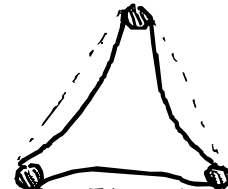
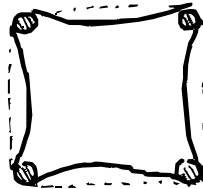
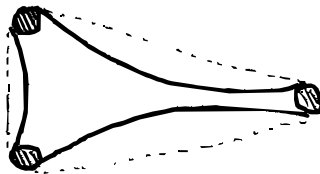
- **property ownership**

If they are your trees – awesome! If they are not? I won't be a prune, just don't hurt the trees. Minimum tree protection level – NO FULL WRAPS of rope around a tree. Maximum – wooden spacers in between rope and the tree.



TREE CHOICE

- net area

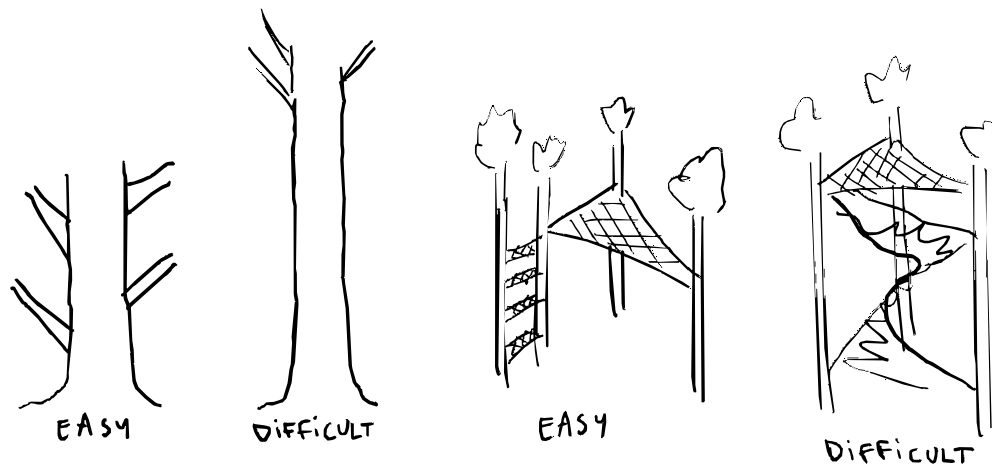


- sun

Nice to sunbathe, BUT sun UV rays eat rope. Any spots of non-black colour on the rope is gone within weeks. I've seen videos of coloured rope disintegrating completely within a year. So it is a choice between sun and net longevity. The rope I use says to be UV resistant. I will report throughout the years how that is holding up...

- getting up to the net

If LOW net – chill. If HIGH? Is it climbable? Or is there a good stair opportunity? Small ladder between very close trees is super simple; a large winding spiral staircase will take more time than three stories of net spanning those same trees.

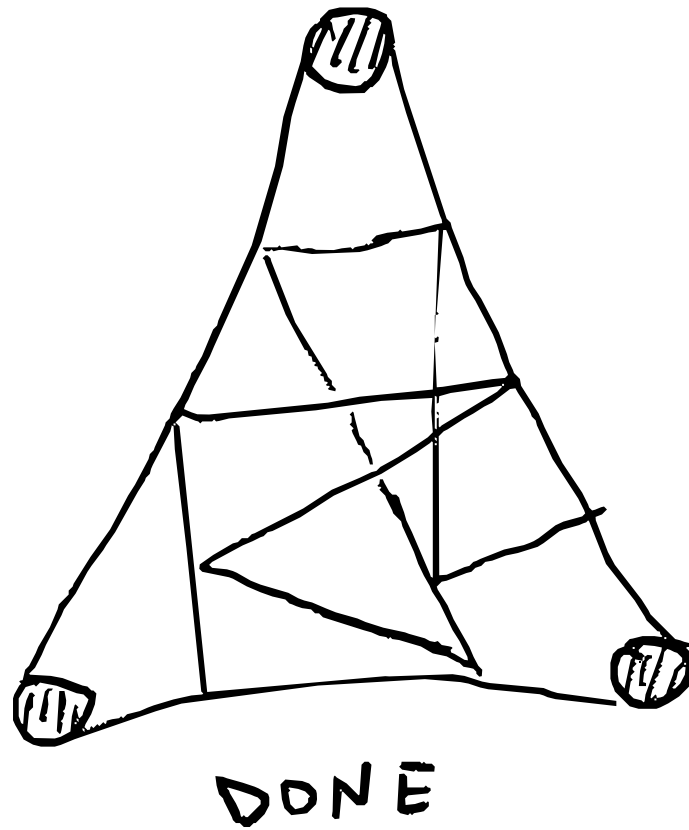


STARTING

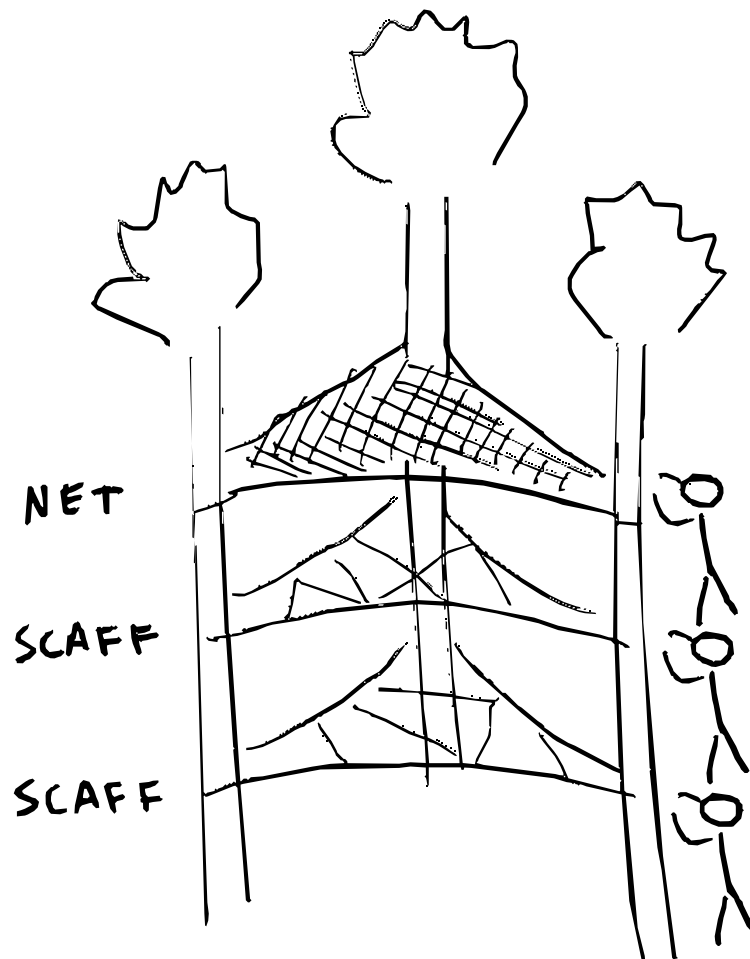
- **good access to your base platform – ground, branches, or scaffolding**

If the net is high, and it isn't trivial to reach every bit of it, MAKE SCAFFOLDING. Don't try to make a three anchor hanging system to float yourself around (I've tried it, very difficult, very slow).

Scaffolding can be made from cheaper rope (I use 12mm PP). You can throw monkey fist knots over branches you can't even reach. Since you will remove scaffolding, you can do full wraps around tree so it secures better. Don't use paracord, only thick rope, since you will frequently stand on a single strand. Only use knots you can untie, so you can remove the net after (alpine butterfly for loops, half hitches for locking on loop, clove hitches everywhere else).



I have made multiple stories of scaffolding, one as high as I could get up to. Second as high as I could get up to from the first. The actual net I could then just about reach from the second story of scaffolding.



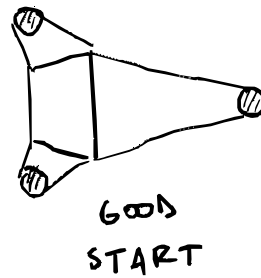
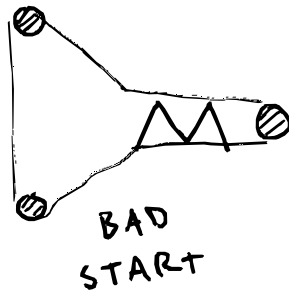
- **rest perimeter rope on branches or bumps**

I don't like to use bolts, I try to get by with natural resting points, with optional paracord tie offs to secure corners with no natural assistance

- **tuck the perimeter knot away from the entrance and the best seating**

Not for structural reason, it just isn't comfortable to step over the knot as it rolls and shifts, as well as it is a big lump to be sitting on

- first (skeleton) weaves located so it least reduces the area



- start weave with doubled paracord

Comfier to sit on initially, when the net is sparse. Also acts as thicker rope that can be clove hitched by paracord later

SIDE WALLS

Mostly all the same, but I like to weave them LOOSER. Comfier to sit when the perimeter isn't pulled up, and the walls are nice to lounge and sink into.

This is as much as I could squeeze into a “starter” checklist. Check out [my current and upcoming videos on youtube](#) for more details. Good luck on your net!

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